

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	13 July 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-7108
Project Name	BookStore
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

1. Before You Collaborate

- Team Gathering: Our team (2–8 members) assembled virtually to review the goals of the BookStore application.
- Set the Goal: The goal is to design an outstanding, cross-platform MERN-stack web application that simplifies book discovery, user reviews, personalized recommendations, and transactions.
- Facilitation Tools: Utilizing interactive digital whiteboards (like Mural/Miro) to map out features synchronously.

2. Define the Problem Statement

To anchor our brainstorming session, we framed our core challenge using the "How Might We" (HMW) methodology:

How might we design a seamless, responsive MERN-stack platform that helps diverse readers effortlessly discover, review, and purchase/reserve books while keeping the experience fast, engaging, and accessible on any device?

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing, and Grouping

Below are the raw ideas brainstormed by our team members, categorized into thematic clusters based on the core pillars of the BookStore pro

BRAINSTORMED IDEAS

Theme A: User Experience & Search		Theme B: Personalized Recommendations
• Advanced multi-genre filter		• AI-driven "Readers Also Bought" engine
• Smart search bar (Auto-complete)		• Personalized reading goals tracker
• Dark mode toggle for night-read		• Recommendation quiz for new users
Theme C: Social & Engagement		Theme D: Transactions & Inventory

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|----------------------------------|--|---|
| • User-written reviews & ratings | | • 1-Click checkout & payment gateway |
| • Community discussion forums | | • Reserve-a-Book (In-store pickup option) |
| • Shared public reading lists | | • Real-time stock status notifier |

Step-3: Idea Prioritization (Importance vs. Feasibility)

To determine which features to build first, we mapped our brainstormed ideas onto a 2D prioritization grid evaluating Feasibility (X-axis: effort, cost, complexity) against Importance (Y-axis: user value, positive impact).

Quadrant	Theory & Description	Core Criteria Evaluated	Strategic Action Plan	Project Examples
(BookStore)				

Zone 1: Quick Wins / MVP

High Importance, High Feasibility

These ideas deliver maximum value to the user and are easy to implement with standard technologies.

- High customer demand
- Low technical complexity
- Fast deployment time

Build First (Core MVP)

These form the backbone of your initial launch.

- Smart search with autocomplete
- Book reservation/checkout
- Multi-genre filtering

Zone 2: Strategic Bets

High Importance, Low/Medium Feasibility

These ideas provide high long-term value but require significant development time, complex algorithms, or higher costs.

- High competitive advantage
- Complex system architecture
- Requires specialized APIs

Plan & Phase In

Break these down into smaller, manageable tasks for future sprints.

- AI-driven "Readers Also Bought" recommendation engine

- Real-time stock notifier

Zone 3: Fill-Ins

Low Importance, High Feasibility

These are low-effort features that are nice to have but do not solve a critical user problem.

- Simple UI/UX adjustments
- Low development overhead
- Optional user preference

Do in Spare Time / Secondary Sprints

Use these to polish the app when core tasks are complete.

- Dark mode toggle for reading at night
- Shareable reading lists
- Reading goals tracker

Zone 4: Thankless Tasks

Low Importance, Low Feasibility

These ideas require high effort but offer very little return on investment.

- High development cost
- Niche or rarely used feature
- Over-engineered solution

Deprioritize / Drop

Shelve these ideas as they distract from building a viable product.

- VR virtual walkthrough of a physical bookstore
- Complex, non-essential discussion forums